

Medal Clash

Basic Rulebook

Version 1.0
October 2026

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Introduction

This is ***Medal Clash***, a fanmade card game based on *Medabots* (*Medarot* in Japan) where two players compete.

Build Medabots, modify them with Medaparts, build up your Leader, and unlock the abilities of your Medals to strengthen your team and defeat your opponent.

Deck Building

Each player will need to bring:

- 1 Leader card
- 3 Medal cards, one of each level
- A Main Deck of 40-50 cards
- A Side Deck of 0-10 cards (optional) for best-of-three matches

There can be up to **3 copies** of the same card in the Main and Side Deck combined. Different cards can have the same name and they won't count for the limit.

Medal Requirements

The cards in your Main and Side Deck have hexagon icons on the right called **Medal requirements**. Each of your Medals will have a color, and the three combined will define what cards go in your deck.

For example, a card with one red  Medal requirement can go in any deck that has at least 1 red Medal. A card with two red  Medal requirements can only go in a deck with 2 or more red Medals. A split Medal requirement like red/blue  means you need a Medal that is either color.

Some examples:

Medal requirements	Your Medals		
			
	Yes	Yes	Yes
	Yes	No	No
	Yes	Yes	No

Initial Setup

To start the game, players must follow these steps in order:

- Each player sets apart their Leader and their 3 Medals and places them on their own field, the Leader in its unbuilt side and the Medals face-down.
- Players set apart their Side Deck (if any).
- Each player shuffles their Main Deck and places it in their deck zone.
- Players use a randomized method (such as rolling dice) to choose a player.
- The randomly chosen player decides who will be the **starting player**.
- Each player draws 6 cards.
- The starting player decides if they want to keep the hand or **mulligan**.
- The non-starting player decides the same.
- Each player who decided to mulligan shuffles their hand back into their deck, and then draws 5 cards. (Only one mulligan can be done.)

After this, the game starts with the starting player taking their first turn.

Best of Three

In a best-of-three match, in between games, players can move cards between their Main Deck and Side Deck. The cards going in don't have to be the same number as the cards going out, as long as the final Main Deck is still 40-50 cards and the final Side Deck is still 0-10 cards.

Leader and Medal cards are not allowed in the Side Deck, so they will be the same for each game.

After side decking, the players follow the initial setup again to start the next game. The only exception is that no randomized method is used to choose the player who decides the starting player. Instead, the player who lost the previous game decides.

Game Flow

Players start the game with all Medals face-down. As the game progresses, Leaders will take damage. With enough damage, they will **level up**, revealing the next Medal card and becoming stronger. However, the player whose Leader is damaged 16 times loses the game.

Each Leader starts at level 0 with  Power/  Armor 10. When a Leader has 4 damage, it will become level 1. This means the level 1 Medal card is turned face-up, making the Leader increase to  Power/  Armor 20, and unlocking the Medal's skill. Every 4 points of damage will continue to level up the Leader until level 3. After that, 4 more damage and the game ends.

Damage	Level	Power/Armor
0-3	0	10
4-7	1	20
8-11	2	30
12-15	3	40
16+	GAME LOST	

For the duration of each level, a Leader can be **built** (see Card Types: Leader). As soon as a Leader levels up, it becomes unbuilt again. It is not mandatory to build the Leader at each level.

Once a Leader levels up, it cannot go down, even if a card effect heals its damage.

Parts of a Card






Name
Main Cost
Trigger Cost
Ghostly Surprise
3
3
Group
Card Type
Event [Rubberobo Gang]
Medal Requirement
■ Target 1 heated Medabot ▶ Destroy it. If it was about to attack, cancel the attack.
■ Trigger: When a card on your field is about to be attacked. (Play this for its Main Cost, or when it Triggers, for its Trigger Cost.)
Skills
A broken heart and Squidguts's false promise turned Yanagi, the Medabot of Kannie's daughter, into the fearful ghost of Mt. Odoro, collecting Medaparts for the Rubberobo.
Flavor Text
Set Info
#1 Core Adventure - 091/218

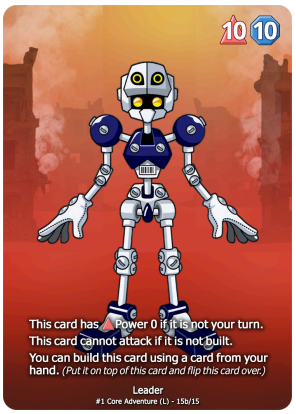

Name
Level
LEVEL
2
Mouse Medal
Power
Armor
30
30
R
■ When you build your Leader ▶ Look at your opponent's hand and discard 1 card from there.
Skill
Medal Color
Medal
Card Type
Set Info
#1 Core Adventure - 213/218

- **Name:** The card's name. Different cards can have the same name.
- **Main Cost:** The energy you spend to play this card in your main phase.
- **Trigger Cost:** The energy you spend to play this card when its Trigger happens (see Playing Cards).
- **Level:** Defines the damage your Leader needs to be turned face-up (see Game Flow). Only in Medals.
- **Power/Armor:** These determine the outcome of a robattle. Only in Leaders and Medabots. (Medals' Power and Armor are applied to the Leader.)
- **Spirit:** Only for Medafighters. Used to pay for their skills.
- **Type/Identity:** Identifies a Medabot series or Medafighter character. Some card effects look for these.
- **Card Type:** Leader, Medal, Medabot, Medapart, Medafighter, Event. Defines the function of the card (see Card Types).
- **Type Icons:** Some card effects look for these. Only in Medabots.
    - **Gender:** Male, Female
    - **Leg Type:** Biped, Multi-Leg, Wheel, Hover, Tank, Flight, Water
    - **Attributes:** Range, Melee, Assist, Ailment, Defense, Morph
- **Groups:** Factions or organizations that the card belongs to. Each phrase in brackets is one group. Some card effects look for these.
- **Medal Requirements:** A card can't go in a deck if their Medal requirements don't match the deck's Medals (see Deck Building: Medal Requirements).
- **Skills:** Allow cards to generate effects in the game.
- **Flavor Text:** Describes lore. Not used for gameplay. Only in Events.
- **Medapart Information:** Shows the cost, name, type and skill when the card is used as a Medapart. Only in Medabots.
    - **Medapart Type:** Head, Right Arm, Left Arm, Legs
- **Set Info:** Shows the set the card comes from and its index within that set.

Card Types

There are 6 types of cards: Leaders, Medals, Medabots, Medaparts, Medafighters and Events. Each has unique rules and characteristics.





Leader

Your Leader represents your partner Medabot that will grow alongside you on your adventure. It starts the game on your field and remains there for the whole game. It can attack and be attacked. All Leaders work the same, so choose your favorite.

A Leader card has two sides: the unbuilt side, and the built side. You can **build** your Leader by flipping it and placing 1 card from your hand face-down under it. When it levels up, it will become unbuilt again and the card under it is moved to the trash. While your Leader is unbuilt, it cannot attack.

Immediately after your Leader finishes attacking, you may choose to damage it once. This can be useful if you're trying to level it up and your opponent is not attacking it.

Whether built or unbuilt, your Leader will always have Power 0 during your opponent's turn, meaning it cannot retaliate in robattle.



Medals

Medals are the soul of your Leader, giving it its personality and particular fighting style, and evolving as it becomes more experienced. Your three Medals start the game on your field face-down, and turn face-up as your Leader levels up during the game.

The face-down side of the Medal card reveals its color and level, but not what Medal card it is. Your opponent will know your Medals only after they turn face-up. Once a Medal is face-up, its skill will start working, and the printed Power/Armor will be used for your Leader.

Your Medals will normally remain on your field for the whole game, as your opponent has no way to destroy them. However, some level 3 Medals have a **Medaforce** skill that require you to destroy it as a last-ditch effort, turning your Leader back to level 2 for the rest of the game.



Medabots

Medabots are customizable robots made to compete. They go on your field. From there, they can **robattle** to damage your opponent's Leader or destroy their Medabots, but they can also be destroyed. Some Medabots are less useful for robattle and instead have powerful skills. You can have up to 5 Medabots on your field at the same time.

Note that even though your Leader is thematically a Medabot, both card types are distinct, and card effects will specify if they can affect Leaders, Medabots or both.



Medaparts

Medaparts are swappable body pieces used to customize Medabots. Instead of playing a card as a Medabot, you can play it as a Medapart, equipping it to another Medabot to strengthen it or give it a useful skill. You can do this from your hand, field or Medawatch. Medaparts can only equip Medabots, never Leaders.

Medaparts are played by paying their Medapart Cost, not the Main Cost of the card. While on the field, they only have the characteristics on the bottom. They don't share the Medabot's name, types, skills, etc.

When equipping a Medabot, place the Medapart under it such that everything is covered except for the Medapart information. Each Medabot can have multiple Medaparts, but only one of each Medapart Type at the same time. If you wish to play, for example, a Head Medapart on a Medabot that already has one, you will have to destroy the old one first.

Medaparts stay on the field until the equipped Medabot moves to another zone. At that point, they will be destroyed and move to the trash. Even if a Medabot on the field is played as a Medapart, its old Medaparts will be destroyed. They won't pass over to the new equipped Medabot.

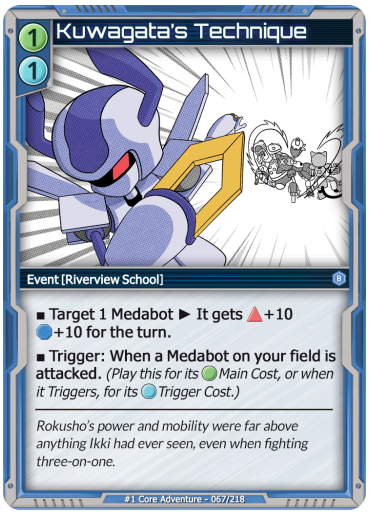


Medafighters

Medafighters are people who command Medabots, friends that come to your aid. Medafighters go on your field, but they cannot attack or be attacked. You can have up to 3 Medafighters on your field at the same time.

When you play a Medafighter, you will also add a number of **Spirit markers** equal to the printed Spirit. You can represent these markers with a die. Medafighters' skills will require you to spend their Spirit markers, i.e., reduce the number indicated by the die. Once a Medafighter has no Spirit markers, it is destroyed and moved to the trash.

If a skill requires you to spend a certain amount of Spirit markers, it needs to have at least that many, or else you cannot use that skill. However, if it requires you to spend "all" Spirit markers, any amount will work.



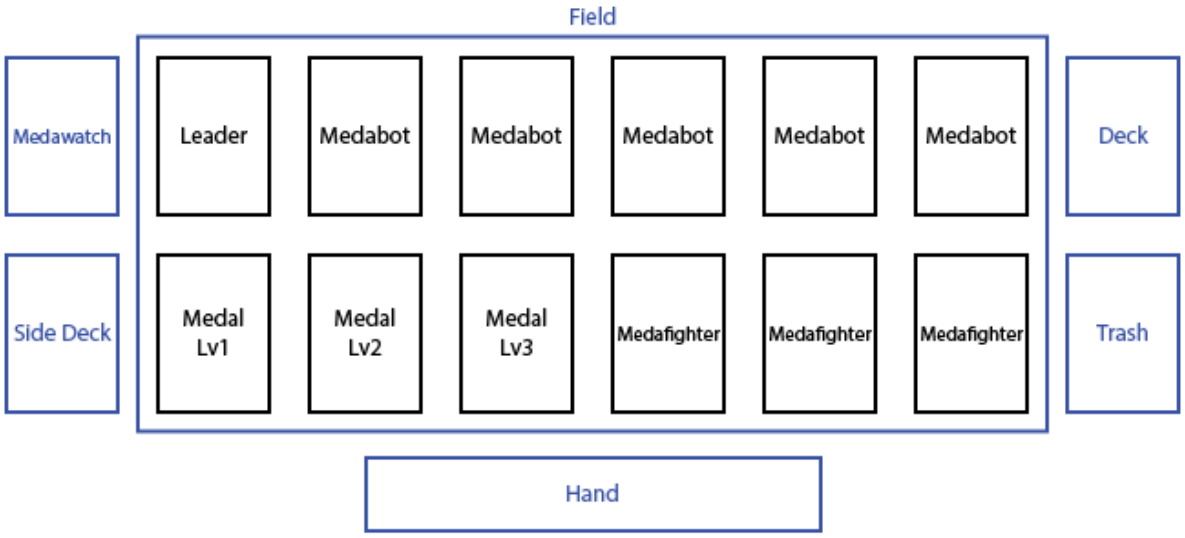
Events

Events are important moments in the story. When you play an Event, you apply its effects, and then it goes to your trash. It never goes to your field.

Event cards often have italic text under their skills called **flavor text**, narrating the lore or story moment. Flavor text is there for narrative purposes, but it has no impact on gameplay.

Zones

Throughout the game, cards will be moved throughout different spaces known as **zones**. Each player has their own set of zones. It is recommended to use the following layout. If not possible, zones must still be clearly distinguished.



List of Zones

Deck: Your cards start the game here after being shuffled, and this is where you draw from. Nobody can look at or reorder cards here.

Hand: This is where your drawn cards go. You can play cards from here. Only you can look at (and reorder) cards in your hand, your opponent cannot.

Field: This is where your Leader and Medals start, and where Medabots and Medafighters are played to. It is visible to both players except for face-down cards.

In addition to your 1 Leader and 3 Medals, your field can have up to 5 Medabots and up to 3 Medafighters. Medaparts equipped to Medabots do not have a limit. If you have reached the Medabot or Medafighter limit on your field, you can still play a new one, but you will first have to destroy an old one.



Cards on the field can be **cooled** in an upright position, or **heated** in a sideways position. Medabots need to become heated from a cooled position to be able to attack, and many cards also need to do this to use their skills. All heated cards on your field become cooled at the start of your turn.

Trash: This is where Events go after being played, and where cards go after being **discarded** or **destroyed**. It is always visible to both players.

Medawatch: Cards only go here by effects. It is visible to both players. You can play Medaparts (but not Medabots) from your Medawatch.

Transport: Cards go through here before being played. (See Playing Cards)

Side Deck: During a game, your side deck must remain in a face-down pile. Cards in there cannot enter the game, but you can look at them. The Side Deck is used to replace cards in your Main Deck in best-of-three matches.

Card Ownership by Zone

Most of the time, a player's cards can only be in their own zones, but some effects move cards to one of the other player's zones. This is temporary and the cards will return to their owner at the end of the game or when they move to specific zones.

Effects can move cards to these opponent's zones:

- Field
- Medawatch
- Transport

But cards going to these zones will always go to their owner's zones:

- Deck
- Hand
- Trash

Energy & Playing Cards

Energy

To manually play cards, you will need a resource called **energy**. Energy is obtained automatically each turn, and you can represent it with a die in front of your Leader.

When your turn begins, you set your energy to your current turn count. In your first turn, you will have 1 energy. In your second turn, you will have 2 energy, and so on. From your sixth turn onward, you will always reset to 6 energy. Any energy you don't spend will be lost by the start of your next turn. When gaining energy by effects, you can go above the normal 6.

Energy is represented by a circle. If you are required to pay a cost represented by a number within a circle (such as 2), it means you must reduce your current energy by that much. If you don't have enough energy, you can't pay that cost. Main Costs, Medapart Costs and Trigger Costs are all energy costs.

Playing Cards

During your main phase, you can **play a card manually** by paying its Main Cost (or Medapart Cost if it's a Medapart). Most cards can only be played from your hand, but Medaparts can also be played from your Medawatch and from Medabots on your field. If a card has no Main Cost, it cannot be played manually.

Cards with a Trigger Cost have a Trigger skill that describes a game action, such as "When a card on your field is attacked". When this action happens, you have an opportunity to **play a card by trigger** from your hand by paying its Trigger Cost.

If a card has both of these costs, you can play them either way.

Additionally, some skills allow you to **play a card by effect**. In this case, you don't pay any energy cost. Each effect will specify what card will be played, and from which zone (not always from your hand). When playing a Medabot by effect, you always play the Medabot side, not the Medapart side, unless it specifically says "as a Medapart". When playing a Medapart by effect, you choose what Medabot to equip, unless the effect specifically selects one.

Cards/skills are not played immediately. First, they will be "about to be played" (and cards are moved to the transport, see Zones). Skills such as "When your opponent is about to play a card" will trigger and can **cancel the play**. If so, the cards/skills will not apply their effects (and cards will go to the trash). Otherwise, the cards/skills are finally considered "played" (and cards will be moved to the appropriate zone).

Game Phases

Each turn progresses by following these phases, with players alternating turns until the game is over.

Begin Phase

The turn player performs these actions in order:

- **Reset:** They set their energy to their current turn count.
    - However, on the first turn of the non-starting player, they will set their energy to 2 instead of 1.
- **Cool:** They cool all heated cards on their field.
- **Draw:** They draw 1 card.
    - However, on the first turn of the starting player, they will not draw.
    - If they have no cards in their deck, their Leader will take 1 damage.

After these, skills such as “When you begin your turn” will trigger. When no skills are left pending, the Main Phase begins.

Main Phase

The turn player can choose to do any of the following **manual actions**, any number of times:

- **Build their Leader** (see Card Type: Leader).
- **Play a card:** They can pay the Main Cost of a card in their hand to play it.
- **Play a Medapart:** They can pay the Medapart Cost of a Medabot on their field, or a card in their hand or Medawatch to play the Medapart side of that card equipped to another Medabot on their field.
- **Play a manual skill:** The turn player can pay the cost of a skill that includes the phrase “you can” to play it, provided they meet the conditions.
- **Attack:** The turn player can heat a Leader/Medabot on their field to declare an attack (see Robattle).
- **Pass the turn:** The turn player can end their Main Phase.

Performing one of these actions can cause skills or cards to trigger. In that case, the player must wait until no skills are left pending before they do any more manual actions. When attacking, the whole robattle process must also finish to continue.

Pass Phase

Skills such as “When you pass the turn” will trigger (but the turn is not over yet). When no skills are left pending, the turn ends and the next player’s turn begins.

Robattle

Robattles can be started by a manual attack or by effect. A robattle always involves a Leader/Medabot attacking another Leader/Medabot, and it results in some of them being damaged or destroyed.

Robattle process

A single robattle follows a series of steps with multiple pauses for skills to trigger, similar to phases in the turn:

1. An attacking Leader/Medabot and an attacked Leader/Medabot are chosen

When doing a **manual attack**, the turn player chooses both but they must meet the following conditions.

The attacking card must:

- Be on the turn player's field
- Be built, if it's a Leader
- Not have been played this turn by the turn player, if it's a Medabot
- Be cooled before the attack

The attacked card must:

- Be on the opponent's field
- Be heated if it's a Medabot

The turn player also heats the attacking card as part of the attack declaration.

When doing an **attack by effect**, any two Leader/Medabots can be involved as defined by the effect, and it's not necessary to heat the attacking card. If the effect doesn't specify, it doesn't matter which cards are cooled or heated, whether they are Medabots played this turn, and even whether they are on the same player's field.

2. The attacking card is considered to be "about to attack"

At this point, skills such as "When a card is about to attack" will trigger. Some of these are able to **cancel the attack**. This means that the rest of the robattle will not proceed, the cards involved are not considered to have attacked or been attacked, and skills such as "When this card attacks" will not trigger.

When no skills are left pending, the robattle process continues. If the attack was canceled, instead the Main Phase continues.

3. The attacking card is considered to have attacked

Skills such as "When this card attacks" and "When a card on your field is attacked" will trigger.

Some of these such as the Guard skill can cause a card to **block**. When a card blocks an attack, that card is now considered to be the attacked card, and the previous attacked card is no longer involved in the robattle. A card cannot block if it's already being attacked, and a card can never block its own attack.

When no skills are left pending, the robattle process continues.

4. The outcome of the robattle is determined

Based on the Power and Armor of the cards involved in the robattle at this moment, different outcomes will happen:

- If a Leader's Armor is equal to or less than the other card's Power, the Leader is marked to be **damaged**.
- If a Medabot's Armor is equal to or less than the other card's Power, the Medabot is marked to be **destroyed**.

This can result in both, one, or none of the cards being damaged or destroyed.

If a permanent effect (such as "Your opponent cannot destroy this card by robattle") prevents one of these outcomes, it will not be marked to happen in the first place.

5. The outcome of the robattle is considered to be "about to happen"

Skills such as "When your opponent is about to destroy a Medabot on your field" will trigger. Some of these can **cancel the destruction**, in which case the card will no longer be marked for destruction.

When no skills are left pending, the robattle process continues.

6. The outcome of the robattle happens

Leaders marked for damage will be damaged and Medabots marked for destruction will be destroyed, simultaneously. Skills such as "When your Leader is damaged" or "When this card is destroyed" will trigger at this time. Both outcomes are considered to be done "by robattle", by the opposing card, and by the player whose field has the opposing card.

When no skills are left pending, the robattle process ends.

7. The cards finish robattling

Skills such as "When this card finishes attacking" will trigger at this time, but it won't be considered to be during the robattle anymore. When no skills are left pending, the Main Phase continues, and the turn player can perform manual actions again.

Skills and effects

A **skill** is a characteristic of a card. A card's skills are written in text and each begins with a black square (■). They can also be granted by effects. An **effect** is any game action or modification that happens because of a card's skill.

Types of skills

- **Permanent skills:** These create ongoing effects without any player input.
- **Playable skills:** These use the symbol "►" and have to be played, at which point one or more effects will occur. Playing skills is similar to playing cards, but the costs are written on the skill and are not always energy costs.
    - **Manual skills:** These use the phrase "you can" and are played in the Main Phase (see Game Phases). Manual skills are always optional.
    - **Triggered skills:** These start with "When" and happen on their own after a game action matches its trigger. If they use the phrase "you may", they're optional. Otherwise, they're mandatory.

Parts of a skill

- **Trigger:** This game action will cause the triggered skill to trigger.
- **Conditions:** If these are not met:
    - A permanent skill is not "active" and none of its effects work.
    - A playable skill cannot be played. Conditions are checked when a player tries to play the skill, not during the trigger.
- **Optionality:** Manual skills use the phrase "you can" and are always optional. Triggered skills are optional only if they use the phrase "you may".
- **Costs:** A player must pay these in order to play the skill.

Examples of skills

"■ If this card is Medapart-equipped, it has Laser." This is a permanent skill. While the condition is true (the card has a Medapart on it), the card will be granted Laser, which is a separate skill. As soon as the Medapart is removed, it will immediately stop working and the card will lose the Laser skill.

"■ When you play a Medapart, once per turn ► Draw 1 card." This is a mandatory triggered skill. When the trigger first happens in a turn, the player is obligated to play the skill and draw. If it triggers again on the same turn, it won't be able to be played.

"■ When your Leader is damaged by robattle/effect, once per turn, you may discard 1 card ► Draw 1 card." This is an optional triggered skill. When the trigger happens, the player can choose to discard or not. If they do, they'll draw and they won't be able to play the skill again for the rest of the turn. If they don't, they'll still get another chance when it triggers again.

Types of effects

- **Ongoing effect:** These constantly modify the game. Examples: Increasing a Medabot's  Power, granting a skill, allowing you to attack cooled Medabots.
- **Atomic effect:** These cause a one-shot game action to be performed. Examples: Moving a card to a different zone, cooling or heating cards on the field, damaging Leaders, starting robattles, playing cards by effects.

Scope of Skills

Most skills work if and only if a card is on the field. In other zones, their effects don't work, and they cannot be triggered or played. These are the exceptions:

- Medals' skills work on the field, but only while they are face-up.
- Medabots and Medaparts are separate. One such card on the field will only have the skills of the corresponding side.
- Trigger skills (to play a card for its  Trigger Cost) work from the hand.
- Permanent skills that reduce or set a card's own cost work while you're paying to play it. Example: ■ If your Leader is level 2 or more, and you damaged it by effect this turn, reduce this card's cost by  .
- Event skills work as part of playing a card.
- "When you are about to play this card" works as part of playing a card.

Scope of Effects

If a playable skill creates an ongoing effect (for example, "The target gets  +10 for the turn."), that effect will last as long as the skill defines it, even if the card that created the effect leaves or loses the skill.

However, if a permanent skill is continuously creating an ongoing effect (for example, "■ All Medapart-equipped Medabots on your field have  +10  +10."), that effect will end if the card leaves the field, loses the skill or stops meeting its conditions.

Ongoing effects that were created to affect a particular card will only work while that card remains in the same zone. As soon as it moves, the effect stops affecting that card.

Keywords

Many common skills and effects are represented by **keywords**, short phrases that abbreviate a complex functionality. Keywords have **reminder text** in parenthesis explaining them most of the time, but it's still useful to be familiar with them.

- **Chain Reaction:** Makes a Leader/Medabot damage Leaders that it robattles twice instead of once. The damage is done one at a time.
    - If the opposing Leader levels up after the first damage, its  Armor will update immediately, and this can make the second damage miss.
    - If a card with Chain Reaction gets a second instance of Chain Reaction, it will still only damage twice.
- **Destroyer:** Makes a Leader/Medabot always destroy Medabots that it robattles, regardless of its  Power or the opposing Medabot's  Armor.
- **Evasion:** "When you pass the turn ► Cool this card."
- **Guard:** "When another card on your field is attacked, you may cool this card ► This card blocks the attack."
- **Gravity:** Allows a Leader/Medabot to manually attack a cooled Medabot with less  Power than it.
- **Laser:** Makes a Leader/Medabot that destroys a Medabot by robattle also robattle the Leader on the latter's field, potentially damaging it.
    - The robattle against the Leader will go through even if the Medabot with Laser was destroyed in the same robattle. Its  Power will be compared as it was before destruction.
- **Medaforce:** Destroys the Medal to use. Only in level 3 Medals.
- **Melee Mastery:** Makes a Leader/Medabot unable to be damaged/destroyed by robattle by a non-  Melee Medabot.
- **Propulsion:** Allows a Medabot to manually attack the turn you play it.
- **Protection:** Makes your opponent unable to target the card.
- **Range Mastery:** Makes a Leader/Medabot unable to be damaged/destroyed by robattle by a non-  Range Medabot.
- **Recycle:** "When this card is destroyed ► Move it from your trash to your Medawatch."
- **Stop:** Gives an ongoing effect to a card that makes it unable to attack, block or become cooled. The card will remain Stopped until the start of the next turn of the player who Stopped it. It can still be attacked.
- **Support:** "You can cool this card and target 1 Medabot ► The targets gets  +10 for the turn."
- **Tank:** "When you play this card ► Heat it." Appears on  Tank Medabots.
- **Trigger:** Allows a card to be played by paying its  Trigger Cost when the trigger happens.

Triggered skills and order of effects (advanced)

Game actions can cause multiple skills to trigger at the same time, and those same skills can then cause other skills to trigger. The following section describes how to resolve the order in which these skills can be played.

A player initiates a **checkpoint** when they do any of the following:

A. Performs the three Begin Phase actions (see Game Phases: Begin Phase)
B. Is “about to play” a card/skill
C. Plays a card/skill
D. Makes a card be “about to attack” (see Robattle, step 2)
E. Makes a card attack (see Robattle, step 3)
F. Makes a robattle outcome happen (see Robattle, step 6)
G. Is “about to destroy” a card
H. Destroys a card
I. Passes the turn (see Game Phases: Pass Phase)

In between checkpoints, one or more game actions can occur and cause skills to trigger. Those skills are not played immediately. Instead, they will be left **pending**. Pending skills are grouped by **timestamp**, the checkpoints in between which they triggered. For example, if “When you cool this card” and “When you draw a card” both trigger during the Begin Phase, they will have the same timestamp, even though cooling happened before drawing.

Checkpoints start **unresolved**. During a checkpoint, the player who initiated the current checkpoint has the opportunity to play one of their pending skills if its timestamp is the latest. If they don’t play anything, they permanently pass the opportunity to the other player. To play a pending skill, its conditions must be met and its costs must be paid, if any. Optional skills can be declined, but mandatory skills must be played (unless their conditions are not met).

Cards with a Trigger Cost have a Trigger skill that works from a player’s hand. These skills will also have a timestamp, but they will be hidden from the other player. Playing a card by trigger works the same as playing a triggered skill, except that the player has to reveal the card from their hand. Its conditions must be met and the costs must be paid, including the Trigger Cost.

If a pending skill is declared to be played, a new checkpoint will occur, and the skill will be considered “about to be played”. Any skills that triggered since the previous checkpoint will now be the pending skills with the latest timestamp. This includes skills such as “When your opponent is about to play a card/skill” and those that triggered from costs being paid. The skill that is “about to be played” is kept waiting, and the checkpoint process restarts.

If no pending skill is played during a checkpoint, that checkpoint becomes **resolved**, and what initiated it determines what happens next:

A. The Main Phase begins
B. The card/skill is played: non-Event cards are moved to the field, Events/skills apply its effects, and Event cards are moved to the trash
C. Nothing
D. The card attacks (see Robattle step 3)
E. The robattle outcome is determined (see Robattle step 4)
F. The robattle ends and the Main Phase continues
G. The card is destroyed
H. Nothing
I. The turn ends.

If no actions are taken, the game goes back to the latest unresolved checkpoint. If there are no unresolved checkpoints left and it's the Main Phase, the turn player can continue taking manual actions.

Example

It's Alice's Main Phase. She tries to manually play Phantom Strike, an Event that reads ■ Target 1 Medabot with  Power 30 or less ▶ Destroy it. To do this, she moves the card to her transport, pays its  Main Cost and targets Bob's Clawcray, which has  Power 10.

She initiates Checkpoint 1 (reason B) but has nothing else to play, so she waits for Bob's response. Bob has nothing to play either, so he says "Ok". Checkpoint 1 resolves and so the card/skill that was "about to be played" will now be played.

Alice now resolves Phantom Strike: First, its effects are applied, and Clawcray is marked for destruction. Then, she moves Phantom Strike to her trash.

Alice initiates Checkpoint 2 (reasons C & G). Again, she has nothing to play and waits for Bob's response. Bob says "Ok". Checkpoint 2 resolves and so the Medabot that was "about to be destroyed" will now be destroyed.

Alice sends Clawcray to Bob's trash. This destruction triggers two skills on the field. Alice's Desperado has a skill that reads ■ When another Medabot/Medafighter is destroyed ▶ Send the top 2 cards of your opponent's deck to their trash. Bob's Hachiro Awano has a skill that reads ■ When a Medabot on your field is destroyed, you may spend all  ▶ Play 1 Medabot with  Main Cost 2 or less or the  Wheel type from your trash.

Alice initiates Checkpoint 3 (reason H). Because she has a mandatory skill with Timestamp 3, she needs to play something now. However, even though Desperado's skill is her only visible skill with Timestamp 3, she instead tries to play a card from her hand that also fits with Timestamp 3. She reveals Tournament Sponsor from her hand, an Event that reads ■ Draw 2 cards. ■ Trigger: When a Medabot/Medafighter is destroyed. She pays the  Trigger Cost and moves the card to the transport.

Alice initiates Checkpoint 4 (reason B) and waits for Bob. Bob says "Ok". Checkpoint 4 resolves and Alice draws 2 cards and moves the Event to her trash.

Alice initiates Checkpoint 5 (reason C) but nobody has anything to play. Checkpoint 5 resolves but causes no further actions, so now the game goes back to the latest unresolved checkpoint: Checkpoint 3, when Clawcray was just destroyed.

Alice again has the opportunity to play something with Timestamp 3. She has no other optional pending skills, so she must try to play Desperado's skill.

Alice initiates Checkpoint 6 (reason B) and waits for Bob. Bob says "Ok". Checkpoint 6 resolves and Alice sends the top 2 cards of Bob's deck to his trash. One of those cards is another Desperado card.

Alice initiates Checkpoint 7 (reason C) but nobody has anything to play. Back to Checkpoint 3.

Alice again has the opportunity to play something with Timestamp 3. This time she has nothing to play, so Bob finally gets the opportunity. Bob tries to play Hachiro Awano's skill, spends all the Medafighter's  Spirit and moves it to his trash.

Bob initiates Checkpoint 8 (reason B) and waits for Alice. Alice says "Ok". Checkpoint 8 resolves and Bob tries to play his own Desperado, moving it from his trash to his transport. No costs are paid to play a Medabot by effect.

Bob initiates Checkpoint 9 (reasons B & C) and waits for Alice. Alice says "Ok". Checkpoint 9 resolves and Bob plays his Desperado, moving it from his transport to his field. Bob initiates Checkpoint 10 (reason C) but nobody has anything to play. Back to Checkpoint 3.

Bob has the opportunity to play something else with Timestamp 3. Even though Alice initiated Checkpoint 3, she has already passed the opportunity here, so she doesn't get a chance to play anything else with Timestamp 3.

Bob would like to play the skill of his own Desperado, since Timestamp 3 is for skills right after Clawcray's destruction. However, Desperado was not on the field to trigger at that time, so he's unable to play that skill.

With both players passing on the last unresolved checkpoint, no pending skills are left, and the Main Phase continues. Alice can now do another manual skill.

Glossary

Attack: The start of a robattle. “When a card attacks” triggers at the start of a robattle (if the attack isn’t canceled). During the entire robattle process, the card that initiated the robattle is “attacking”.

Block: When a card blocks an attack, it becomes the attacked card in the robattle, and the previously attacked card stops being part of the robattle.

Build: To turn a Leader from its unbuilt side to its built side. You can build a Leader by placing 1 card from your hand face-down under it (see Card Types: Leader).

Cancel: To cancel something prevents it from happening. You can cancel a play, an attack or a destruction.

Cool/Cooled: A cooled card is in an upright position. To “cool” a card means to change it from heated to cooled. A card becomes cooled to attack or by effects.

Damage: Happens by robattle or effect and accumulates in a Leader. Damage makes a Leader level up (turn a Medal face-up). A player whose Leader has 16+ damage loses the game.

Destroy: When a card is destroyed, it is moved from the field to the trash. Medabots can be destroyed by robattle. Medaparts are destroyed when the equipped Medabot leaves the field. Medafighters are destroyed when they have no more Spirit. Any card on the field can be destroyed by effect. Some effects can prevent a destruction from happening, or cancel it when it is about to happen.

Discard: To move a card from your hand to the trash.

Effect: A game action or modification caused by a card skill. Game actions defined by the rules and not by individual cards are not effects.

Equipped: If a Medapart refers to “Equipped Medabot”, it means the Medabot that has that Medapart on it. If a card refers to a “Medapart-equipped” Medabot, it means a Medabot has at least one Medapart on it.

Event: A card type. When played, they do their effects and go to the trash.

Heat/Heated: A heated card is in a sideways position. To “heat” a card means to change it from cooled to heated. A card becomes heated by an effect or when the player who has it on their field begins their turn.

Leader: A card type. They start on your field, and can attack and be damaged.

Level: A Leader’s level is equal to the number of face-up Medals on the same field.

Marker: An element that goes on a card for as long as it’s on the field. You can represent markers with a die.

Medabot: A card type. They are played on the field and can attack.

Medal: A card type. You start with three on your field, one of each level, and turn them face-up as your Leader increases in damage.

Medapart: A card type. Medaparts have their information on the bottom of Medabot cards. They must be played equipped to a Medabot, and are destroyed when that Medabot leaves the field.

Medawatch: A zone from where you can play Medaparts.

Once Per Turn: A condition. If a skill says “once per turn”, it cannot be played if it was attempted to be played previously in the turn, even if the play was canceled.

Robattle: The process that starts with an attack declaration and ends with some of the cards involved being destroyed or damaged.

Skill: The text on cards that cause game effects to happen. Each skill is separated by a paragraph and a black square (■), except in Medaparts.

Spirit: The amount of Spirit markers that a Medafighter on the field has. For Medafighter cards outside the field, it refers to the printed number on the top right.

Target: When a player is asked to “target”, they must select a card on the field that fits the description. Targeting is a cost, so if there is nothing to select, the cost can’t be paid, and the associated Event/skill cannot be played. Choosing a card in any other context is not targeting.

Token: Tokens are cards played by effects that come from outside of the player’s deck lists. They cannot be moved to a player’s hand or deck, and they’re removed when they would be moved to a Medawatch or trash.